Off the Beaten

NAGA CHAITANYA MAKES HIS STREAMING DEBUT WITH *DHOOTHA*, WHERE HIS CHARACTER IS IN STARK CONTRAST TO HIS ROMANTIC HERO IMAGE IN TELUGU CINEMA





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An actor turning up on time for an interview is such a rarity that by now the Mumbai press circle has reluctantly made peace with 'Bollywood Standard Time'. Telugu actor Naga Chaitanya though doesn't abide by it even if he is in Mumbai to promote his streaming debut, *Dhootha* (Amazon Prime), and has one Hindi film to his credit, *Laal Singh Chaddha*. He walks into a banquet hall at ITC Maratha dot at 10 am.

With *Dhootha* (releasing on December 1), a Telugu supernatural thriller, the actor joins a small legion of South actors (Rana Daggubati, Nithya Menen, Arya to name a few) who have jumped on the OTT bandwagon to do shows in the region's many languages. Doing a web series was a no-brainer for the 37-year-old actor as it gave him more screen time to explore his craft. "It was never like

WATCHLIST

Other horror flicks on OTT

STRANGER THINGS, *(Netflix)*



There are monsters, a girl with superpowers, bad scientists, a good cop, adorable friends and more in this show, which has inspired a cult-like following now. That it is set in the 1980s and includes plenty of pop culture references from the period has only added to its charm.

